

Why Payers Love Denial Code CO-16

(And How to Defeat It)

The 3-step protocol for overturning the most common delay tactic in commercial healthcare.

What CO-16 Really Means

Payer definition: "Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error."

It is vague by design. Payers use it to force 45-minute hold times and run out your 90-day appeal clock.

The 3 Root Causes

- **NPI Conflict:** Box 33a billing NPI vs Box 24J rendering NPI taxonomy mismatch.
- **Modifier Omission:** Unbundled secondary missing -59, -XE, or -XS.
- **Chart Note Edits:** High-dollar E/M procedures flagged for medical necessity records.

Stop Resubmitting Blindly

Blindly resubmitting without fixing the root cause guarantees a second denial and burns 30 more days.

Always attach the exact missing attachment flagged by the clearinghouse edit before dropping the claim.

Benchmark Your Denials

Is your CO-16 denial rate exceeding 4% of total claims?

Get a free 50-claim pilot review and uncover where your revenue is leaking.

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